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RETURN

IOM Framework: Engaging Diaspora and Supporting Return of Ukrainians

IOM presented a multi-track framework at URC2026 combining resettlement support, protection activities, and diaspora engagement mechanisms. The approach emphasizes that return must be voluntary, safe, and dignified, requiring coordinated investment in reception infrastructure and reintegration services to convert diaspora intent into actual movement.

3R: Provides the institutional blueprint for Return programming; identifies concrete levers (reception hubs, counselling, legal support) that policymakers and donors should fund to translate the 53% intent into arrivals.

UKRAINE.IOM.INT

53% of Ukrainian EU Migrants Intend to Return Home — Gradus Survey

A Gradus survey of Ukrainian migrants in the EU found 53% intend to return, 31% do not plan to return, and 66% cannot yet say when. The data signals a large but time-sensitive pool of potential returnees whose decisions will hinge on security conditions, economic opportunity, and family circumstances in the near term.

3R: The single most quantified Return signal this week; the 31% firm non-returners already represent permanent human capital loss, making urgency of return-enabling policies acute.

LINKEDIN.COM / GRADUS

IOM Poland: 5.5 Million Previously Displaced Have Returned, 15% of Population Still Displaced

IOM Poland reported at URC2026 that 5.5 million people who were previously displaced have returned to Ukraine, mostly internally, while 15% of the total population remains displaced. This establishes a baseline: internal return flows are substantial, but external diaspora return lags significantly, requiring differentiated policy instruments.

3R: Contextualizes the scale of return already achieved and the gap that remains; distinguishes IDP return (largely achieved) from diaspora return (largely pending), informing resource allocation priorities.

FACEBOOK.COM / IOM POLAND

NRC: Ukraine's Recovery Risks Leaving Millions Behind — 3.42M IDPs and 4.2M Returnees as of May 2026

The Norwegian Refugee Council warns that recovery processes are not reaching the most vulnerable, including 3.42 million IDPs and 4.2 million returnees who face inadequate housing, services, and economic inclusion. Without targeted support, return becomes a poverty trap rather than a recovery asset.

3R: Critical quality-of-return signal: high returnee numbers mask reintegration failures; policymakers must track returnee economic outcomes, not just headcounts, to assess true Return program success.

RELIEFWEB.INT / NRC

RECRUIT

ILO Local Employment Partnerships: Demand-Driven Skilling in Mykolaiv and Odesa

ILO's Local Employment Partnership (LEP) model in Mykolaiv and Odesa operationalizes employer-led training, reskilling, and upskilling aligned to actual labour market demand. Partnerships connect employers, training providers, and local authorities to fill skill gaps in reconstruction-critical sectors, serving as a scalable recruitment pipeline for both returnees and IDPs.

3R: Flagship Recruit mechanism: LEPs create the absorption capacity needed to make return economically rational; replication across other oblasts is the key scaling lever for human capital recovery.

ILO.ORG

ILO Mykolaiv & Odesa LEP PDF: Employer-Led Training and Vocational Education Updates

The ILO LEP technical report details how employer-driven training curricula were co-designed with businesses, reskilling initiatives were launched, and vocational education systems were

updated to match emerging reconstruction economy needs. The model demonstrates that skills mismatches can be closed within 6–12 months when employers co-invest.

3R: Provides evidence base and replication template for Recruit programming; the 6–12 month cycle time is critical intelligence for workforce planners targeting returnee and IDP cohorts.

ILO.ORG

ILO LEP Action Report: Addressing Labour Market Challenges Through Partnerships

This ILO action report synthesizes LEP outcomes across Ukrainian regions, showing that employer-led training combined with social dialogue mechanisms reduces structural unemployment and creates pathways for economically inactive populations — including displaced women and veterans — to re-enter the labour market.

3R: Broadens Recruit lens beyond skills to include economic activation of marginalized groups; veterans and displaced women are two high-priority cohorts for Ukraine's labour force expansion.

ILO.ORG

VoxUkraine: Economic Impact of Integrating Inactive Ukrainian Women into Employment

VoxUkraine modelling shows that providing retraining and employment to currently unemployed and economically inactive Ukrainians — particularly women — generates substantial GDP uplift. The analysis quantifies the fiscal and productivity case for investing in female labour market activation as a core human capital recruitment strategy.

3R: Provides the economic justification (ROI framing) for Recruit investment in female labour activation; critical for donor and government budget allocation arguments in the recovery context.

VOXUKRAINE.ORG

RETAIN

1.5–2 Million Young Ukrainians Abroad: Razom for Ukraine on Youth Brain Drain Risk

Razom for Ukraine highlights that between 1.5 and 2 million young Ukrainians are currently living abroad due to the war, representing the most acute brain drain cohort. The organization mobilized 30 young Ukrainian leaders from EU, Switzerland, and the US for URC2026, signalling that diaspora youth engagement — not just return — is a retention strategy in itself.

3R: Defines the youth retention/return boundary condition: 1.5–2M young people is the demographic cohort Ukraine can least afford to lose permanently; requires dedicated youth-specific policy instruments beyond generic return programmes.

FACEBOOK.COM / RAZOM FOR UKRAINE

GLOBAL CONTEXT

Migration Policy Institute: Ukrainian Immigrant Population Growth in the United States Post-2022

MPI's Jeanne Batalova documents significant growth of the Ukrainian immigrant population in the US following Russia's 2022 invasion. While the article is a staff profile, it flags MPI as a key data source tracking the North American Ukrainian diaspora — a segment often underrepresented in Europe-centric return surveys and relevant for understanding the full global dispersion of Ukrainian human capital.

3R: Global context signal: US-based Ukrainian diaspora is a separate policy universe from EU-based migrants; dedicated engagement and bilateral frameworks are needed to tap this population's potential contribution to Ukraine's recovery.

MIGRATIONPOLICY.ORG
